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60,000 Protest Bicentennial In Philly

DELLUMS CALLS FOR PUERTO RICAN INDEPENDENCE



Over 60,000 progressive people from 400 political, labor, religious and other groups from all over the country marched in the Philadelphia "People's Bicentennial Celebration" sponsored by the July 4th Coalition.

(Philadelphia, Pa.) - "Viva Puerto Rico Libre!" was the resounding cheer of the 60,000 people gathered here in Fairmount Park on July 4 for this city's "People's Bicentennial Celebration" after they heard the text of a resolution authored by Black California Congressman Ronald Dellums calling on the U.S. government to "unconditionally and without reservations" transfer all its powers in Puerto Rico to the people of that Caribbean island colony.

The resolution — read to the assembled crowd by Black Panther Party chairperson Elaine Brown, a featured speaker at the July 4th Coalition-sponsored march and rally — was submitted to the House of Representatives on July 1. Puerto Rican Socialist Party (PSP) Secretary General Juan Mari Bras, one of the keynote speakers for the day, hailed the Dellums' resolutions as an act of solidarity with Puerto Rico.

"Nobody could validly oppose the formula presented by Representative Dellums," Mari Bras declared. (See page 8 for the text of the resolution.)

The torrential rains that poured down over the city toward the end of the People's Bicentennial Celebration — the largest of four such demonstrations sponsored by the July 4th Coalition across the country — did little to dampen the spirits of the representatives of some 400 political, labor, religious and other groups who came from as far away as Minnesota.

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